



General Assembly

Substitute Bill No. 5456

February Session, 2026



**AN ACT CONCERNING THE NUMBER OF DEPUTY COMMISSIONERS
APPOINTED BY THE COMMISSIONER OF EMERGENCY SERVICES
AND PUBLIC PROTECTION.**

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General
Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Subsection (a) of section 29-1r of the general statutes is
2 repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October*
3 *1, 2026*):

4 (a) There is established a Department of Emergency Services and
5 Public Protection. Said department shall be the designated emergency
6 management and homeland security agency for the state. The
7 department head shall be the Commissioner of Emergency Services and
8 Public Protection, who shall be appointed by the Governor in
9 accordance with sections 4-5 to 4-8, inclusive, with the powers and
10 duties prescribed in said sections. The commissioner shall be
11 responsible for providing a coordinated, integrated program for the
12 protection of life and property and for state-wide emergency
13 management and homeland security. The commissioner shall appoint
14 not more than [two] three deputy commissioners who shall, under the
15 direction of the commissioner, assist in the administration of the
16 department. The commissioner may do all things necessary to apply for,
17 qualify for and accept any federal funds made available or allotted
18 under any federal act for emergency management or homeland security.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
Section 1	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	29-1r(a)

PS *Joint Favorable Subst.*